

UPSC MODERN INDIAN HISTORY

The Decline of the Mughal Empire, 1707-1740s Solved Practice Workbook

Modern Indian History · Prelims + GS-I analytical foundation

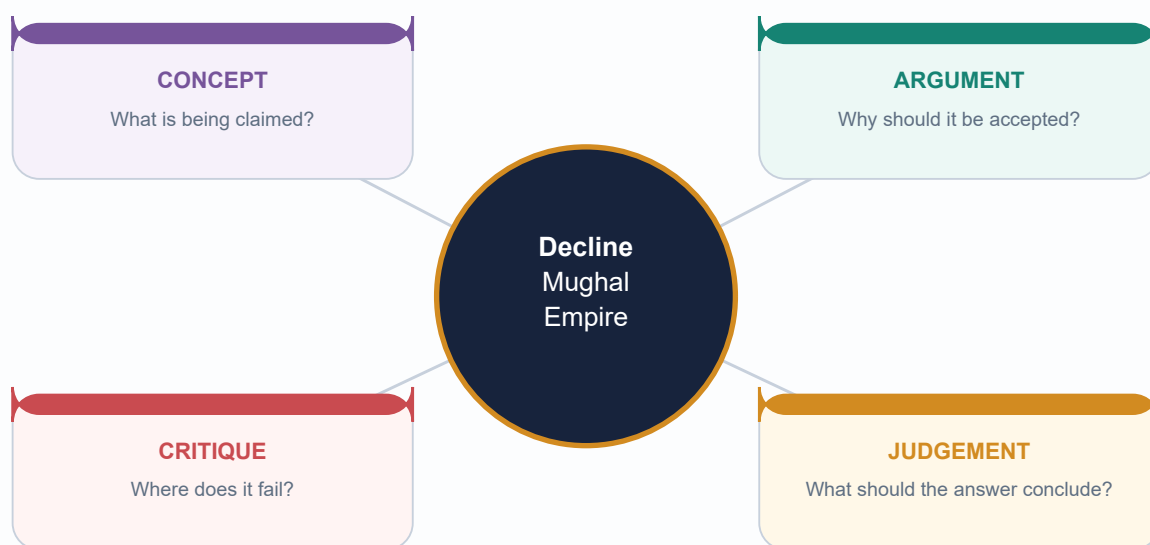
Scope: late-Aurangzeb background, 1707-1740s core, bounded post-1740 consequence

Rendering mode: workbook · Source:

01_The-Dcline-of-the-Mughal-Empire-1707-1740s_Complete-Topic-Package.md

Learning cards: 145

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Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Package Overview

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Paper:** Prelims GS-I + GS-I analytical foundation | **Topic:** 01 | **Regenerated:** 13 August 2026 greater than greater than **Evidence key:** FACT = supported by a named source/event/institution; INTERPRETATION = evidence-led analytical position; LIMIT = what the evidence cannot establish; METHOD = source-use rule; BOUNDARY = context deliberately kept outside the core period. greater than greater than **Approval state:** generated, **approved=false**. Status remains yellow until the user explicitly approves all three deliverables.

HIGH

Package practice counts · Matrix 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Package practice counts.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Component	Count
Verified/routed PYQs	3; two Prelims keys explicitly inferred, one verified adjacent GS-I Mains
Hard MCQs with explanations	48
Remedial MCQs with explanations	12
Original solved 10-mark Mains	3
Original solved 15-mark Mains	3
Original solved 20-mark Mains	3

HIGH

PYQ 01 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q48: eighteenth-century successor states · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verified question: With reference to Indian history, which of the following statements is/are correct?

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- The Nizam of Arcot emerged out of Hyderabad State.
- The Mysore Kingdom emerged out of Vijayanagara Empire.
- Rohilkhand Kingdom was formed out of the territories occupied by Ahmad Shah Durrani.
- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only

HIGH

PYQ 01 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q48: eighteenth-century successor states · 2GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

D. 3 only

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY:** B, 1 and 2 only. Confidence: high. The repository routing verifies the question, but a locally readable UPSC key is unavailable.

- Solved explanation

- Statement 1 is correct in the conventional successor-state genealogy: Arcot or the Carnatic operated under the Deccan/Hyderabad subordination before its nawabs acquired practical autonomy.

- Statement 2 is correct: the Wodeyar kingdom of Mysore emerged from the political field of the Vijayanagara order.

- Statement 3 is incorrect: Rohilla power in Rohilkhand grew from Afghan military settlement and weakening Mughal authority before Ahmad Shah Durrani's major Indian interventions; Durrani did not create it from his occupied territories.

- Topic significance: the question tests whether eighteenth-century states are traced to their correct imperial or regional predecessor and whether later Afghan intervention is projected backward.

HIGH

PYQ 01 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q48: eighteenth-century successor states · 3GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Why this earns marks: It evaluates each statement independently, supplies the political genealogy and marks the unavailable official key rather than presenting an inference as official.

HIGH

PYQ 02 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q45: Mughal administrative hierarchy · 1GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Verified question: With reference to medieval India, which one of the following is the correct sequence in ascending order in terms of size?

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- A. Paragana - Sarkar - Suba

- B. Sarkar - Paragana - Suba

- C. Suba - Sarkar - Paragana

- D. Paragana - Suba - Sarkar

- **INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY:** A, Paragana - Sarkar - Suba. Confidence: high.

- Solved explanation

HIGH

PYQ 02 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q45: Mughal administrative hierarchy · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

A pargana grouped villages and formed the smaller revenue-administrative unit in this sequence.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- A sarkar grouped parganas.
- A subah was the larger province containing sarkars.
- Topic significance: the hierarchy is the territorial skeleton inherited in 1707. Decline occurred when provincial and local officers appropriated power inside this structure, not because the hierarchy instantly disappeared.
- **Why this earns marks:** It gives the exact ascending order and links the fact to the mechanism of provincial autonomy rather than treating it as isolated recall.

HIGH

PYQ 03 - 2022 GS-I Mains Q2: Company armies and Indian rulers

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verified adjacent question: Why did the armies of the British East India Company - mostly comprising Indian soldiers - win consistently against the more numerous and better equipped armies of the then Indian rulers? Give reasons. (10 marks, 150 words)

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Routing note:** The direct owner is Modern History Topic 05. It is included here only as a verified bounded consequence because the 1707-1740s transition created a competitive multi-state field; it did not itself make Company victory inevitable.
- **Model answer**
 - The Company's victories arose less from the ethnicity of its soldiers than from the organisation that converted them into a reliable fiscal-military force. Indian rulers inherited capable cavalry, artillery and revenue systems, but their armies were often composite contingents tied to chiefs. The Mughal experience at **Karnal (1739)** shows how divided command could neutralise numerical strength; Maratha confederate chiefs and successor states later faced similar coordination problems, though in different forms.
 - By contrast, the Company combined regular drill, standardised infantry-artillery coordination and promotion within a single command. Its coastal bases and British naval network sustained supply, while London and Indian merchant credit financed long campaigns. Political intelligence, diplomacy and alliances divided opponents. After **Plassey (1757)** and especially the **Diwani (1765)**, Bengal revenue increasingly funded further war.
 - Yet victory was contingent: Mysore, Marathas and Sikhs repeatedly imposed serious reverses. The decisive advantage was a cumulative organisation-credit-revenue system, not inherent European bravery or Indian military incapacity.
 - **Why this earns marks:** It answers "why" through six mechanisms, uses Karnal only as bounded background, names Plassey and Diwani as later fiscal turning points, and qualifies inevitability with Indian resistance.

HIGH

PYQ coverage conclusionGS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

The audited repository routes one directly relevant eighteenth-century successor-state Prelims question and one administrative-inheritance question. No direct GS-I Mains question confined to Mughal decline in 1707-1740s appears in the audited 2018-2025 route; the verified 2022 Company-armies question is therefore included only as an explicitly bounded bridge. No History Optional question is invented.

HIGH

PART III - HARD MCQ AND REMEDIAL LEARNING LOOPS

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The 60 keys rotate strictly $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$ for fifteen complete cycles. Questions 1-48 are hard coverage questions; Questions 49-60 are remedials targeting predictable misconceptions.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 01 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which formulation best defines Mughal decline in this package?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Loss of enforceable central fiscal-military authority amid continuing institutions and legitimacy
- B. Immediate disappearance of the dynasty in 1707
- C. Uniform collapse of every regional economy
- D. Replacement of Persian administration by Company rule in 1719

- **Answer: A**

- **Explanation:** Decline is level-specific: central command contracted while the dynasty, revenue idiom and cultural order persisted.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 01 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not equate imperial contraction with instant civilisational collapse.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 02 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which sequence correctly describes the administrative scale from smaller to larger?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Subah → pargana → sarkar
- B. Pargana → sarkar → subah
- C. Sarkar → subah → pargana
- D. Pargana → subah → sarkar

- **Answer: B**

- **Explanation:** A pargana grouped villages, a sarkar grouped parganas and a subah was the larger province.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 02 · 2**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: UPSC often reverses the middle and upper units.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 03 · 1**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Be-jagiri most precisely referred to:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Confiscation of all zamindari rights
- B. Permanent hereditary ownership of crown land
- C. Lack or delay of a suitable jagir for a claimant
- D. A Maratha levy on Mughal provinces

- **Answer: C**

- **Explanation:** Be-jagiri identifies assignment scarcity or delay within the mansab-jagir system.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 03 · 2**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: It is not a general word for corruption.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 04 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is the strongest qualification to a single-cause 'weak successors' thesis?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Every post-1707 emperor was militarily stronger than Aurangzeb
 - B. Succession ceased to matter after Bahadur Shah
 - C. Provincial governors possessed no independent revenue base
 - D. Capable nobles existed, but incentives directed their capacity into factional and regional power
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Zulfiqar Khan, the Sayyids, Nizam-ul-Mulk and Murshid Quli Khan show that talent survived while institutional alignment failed.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 04 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not replace a ruler-only thesis with a nobles-only thesis.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 05 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Bahadur Shah I's Deccan policy is best described as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Partial conciliation that recognised sardeshmukhi but failed to settle chauth and Maratha succession
 - B. Full recognition of Tarabai as sole Maratha ruler
 - C. Total military destruction of Maratha power
 - D. Transfer of Hyderabad to the English Company
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** His policy tried accommodation but left Shahu-Tarabai rivalry and fiscal claims unresolved.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 05 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Partial concessions are not the same as a durable settlement.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 06 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Zulfiqar Khan's importance lies primarily in:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Founding the state of Bengal
- B. Showing both the administrative potential and coalition danger of a powerful wazir
- C. Defeating Nadir Shah at Karnal
- D. Abolishing the mansabdari system
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** He pursued conciliation and fiscal restraint, but emperor and nobles feared an over-mighty minister.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 06 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid reducing his career to Jahandar Shah's court anecdotes.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 07 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The Sayyid Brothers' conflict with Farrukhsiyar centred most directly on:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A doctrinal dispute over Sufi orders alone
- B. Whether Persian should replace Turkish
- C. Control of appointments, seal, jagirs, army and provincial resources
- D. Company annexation of Bengal
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** The struggle concerned the operational levers of sovereignty.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 07 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Religious slogans used later by opponents do not define the original institutional dispute.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 08 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about the Sayyid Brothers is incorrect?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. They helped place Farrukhsiyar on the throne
- B. They pursued conciliation with Rajputs, Jats and Marathas
- C. Their deposition of Farrukhsiyar damaged monarchical prestige
- D. They formally abolished the Mughal dynasty and founded their own royal house
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** They remained kingmakers within the Timurid framework and never founded a Sayyid imperial dynasty.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 08 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Kingmaker does not mean emperor.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 09 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The 1718-19 Maratha settlement associated with the Sayyids sought to:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Exchange recognition of Shahu's claims and fiscal rights for service and political support
- B. End all Maratha collection outside the swarajya
- C. Make Nizam-ul-Mulk Peshwa
- D. Transfer Bengal customs to the Marathas
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** The settlement tried to convert conflict into regulated fiscal-military partnership.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 09 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Legal recognition did not guarantee uniform implementation.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 10 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why was Muhammad Shah's early reign still a possible recovery moment?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The jagirdari system had already been abolished
- B. Chronological stability, continuing prestige and surviving military-administrative resources remained
- C. Nadir Shah had become a Mughal ally
- D. All provinces resumed full remittance
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The early 1720s retained resources that a coherent centre might have mobilised.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 10 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Recovery was possible, not assured.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 11 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Nizam-ul-Mulk's move to the Deccan in 1724 is best understood as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A nationalist declaration against all Mughal culture
- B. An English-sponsored conquest of Hyderabad
- C. Conversion of imperial office and military networks into practical regional autonomy
- D. A complete rejection of coins and khutba in the emperor's name
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Hyderabad retained imperial forms while command and revenue became regional.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 11 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Autonomy is not identical to formal modern independence.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 12 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which pairing is correctly matched?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Murshid Quli Khan - foundation of Hyderabad
- B. Nizam-ul-Mulk - foundation of Bengal
- C. Churaman - foundation of the Nizamat of Arcot
- D. Saadat Khan - foundation of autonomous Awadh

- **Answer: D**

- **Explanation:** Saadat Khan was appointed to Awadh in 1722 and built its semi-autonomous order.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 12 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Successor-state founders are a frequent attribution trap.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 13 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Turani, Irani, Afghan and Hindustani labels should be treated as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Recruitment and affinity networks within fluid coalitions
- B. Fixed modern political parties with permanent manifestos
- C. Religious sects with no connection to office
- D. Revenue units below the pargana

- **Answer: A**

- **Explanation:** Origin and kinship mattered, but alliances shifted around office, jagirs and survival.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 13 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not harden flexible court blocs into permanent ethnic parties.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 14 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which mechanism most directly links jagir pressure to military weakness?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Jagirdars were legally forbidden to employ cavalry
- B. Inadequate yields and arrears encouraged mansabdars to maintain fewer troops than sanctioned
- C. Khalisa revenue automatically went to Maratha forts
- D. All artillery was owned by zamindars
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The service bargain failed when paper rank and real fiscal support diverged.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 14 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: A large mansab did not guarantee a field-ready contingent.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 15 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The jama-hasil gap refers to the difference between:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Cavalry rank and infantry rank
- B. Chauth and sardeshmukhi
- C. Assessed revenue and revenue actually realised
- D. Imperial coin and provincial coin
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Paper assessment could exceed collection because of resistance, devastation or administrative weakness.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 15 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not confuse assessment with cash available to the army.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 16 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

John F. Richards's qualification to a simple jagir-shortage thesis stresses that:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. No jagirdari problem existed anywhere
- B. Only religious policy mattered
- C. Bengal had ceased cultivation by 1700
- D. Allocation choices and the treatment of Deccan khalisa could make the crisis partly policy-produced
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Resources, allocation and realisation must be distinguished.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 16 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: A qualification is not a total rejection of fiscal crisis.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 17 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Ijara created which recurring risk?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A contractor's incentive to extract above the fixed payment promised to government
- B. Automatic conversion of peasants into mansabdars
- C. A ban on cash revenue
- D. Permanent restoration of village autonomy
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Revenue farming inserted cash-rich intermediaries whose profit could intensify pressure.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 17 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: It could coexist with commercial sophistication and coercion.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 18 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement best captures zamindars in the Mughal order?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. They were salaried clerks without local ties
- B. They were local right-holders and armed intermediaries whose cooperation or resistance shaped collection
- C. They were identical to European freehold landlords
- D. They had no role in peasant mobilisation
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** Zamindars linked the state to locality and could convert that position into rebellion or rule.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 18 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid both 'mere collector' and 'absolute owner'.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 19 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The most balanced reading of peasant participation in Jat or Sikh assertion is:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Religion alone explains every participant
- B. Peasants acted without any intermediaries
- C. Agrarian grievance became durable through local leadership, identity, forts and armed organisation
- D. Revenue pressure played no role
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Material grievance and political organisation worked together.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 19 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not erase either agrarian structure or identity.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 20 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which claim about eighteenth-century agriculture is safest?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Cultivation stopped throughout India after 1707
- B. Every region experienced equal prosperity
- C. Only European capital financed agriculture
- D. Severe extraction and resistance coexisted with expansion and monetisation in some regions

- **Answer: D**

- **Explanation:** Regional variation is essential to the decline-versus-transition debate.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 20 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not convert a regional example into an all-India total.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 21 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Chauth is best described as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A Maratha claim conventionally represented as one-fourth of assessed revenue
- B. A Mughal tax on non-Muslims
- C. A ten per cent imperial customs duty
- D. The salary rank of a mansabdar

- **Answer: A**

- **Explanation:** Chauth was a fiscal-political claim imposed or negotiated in territories beyond the core swarajya.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 21 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: It was not simply a village land-revenue rate.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 22 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Sardeshmukhi is conventionally distinguished from chauth as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A synonym for imperial khalisa
- B. An additional ten per cent claim linked to superior regional right
- C. A Sikh levy in Punjab
- D. A European sea customs pass
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The two Maratha claims had distinct conventional bases even when bargained together.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 22 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not reverse the quarter and ten-per-cent associations.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 23 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why did the 1718-19 Maratha settlement not end Deccan conflict?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The settlement contained no fiscal provisions
- B. Shahu immediately abolished the Peshwa's office
- C. Competing Maratha, Mughal and Nizam interests made legal recognition difficult to enforce
- D. The Deccan had no local forts or sardars
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** A sanad could frame rights but not eliminate rival collectors and political centres.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 23 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Documentary grant is not uniform implementation.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 24 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Baji Rao I's wider significance within this topic is:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. He led Nadir Shah's Persian army
- B. He founded Awadh in 1722
- C. He restored Mughal control over Punjab
- D. He shifted Maratha strategy toward sustained expansion into Malwa, Gujarat and north Indian politics
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Maratha pressure moved from Deccan survival to wider fiscal and political reach.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 24 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Reach should not be equated with uniform territorial administration.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 25 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Churaman is associated with:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Jat power in the Agra-Mathura region
- B. Sikh mobilisation at Lohgarh
- C. Hyderabad's foundation
- D. Persian victory at Karnal
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Churaman's networks illustrate fortified zamindari and negotiated resistance.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 25 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not confuse Jat and Sikh leaders.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 26 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Banda Bahadur's movement is important because it:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Created the twelve misls after 1765 within this period
- B. Combined Sikh political-religious mobilisation with a major challenge to Mughal authority in Punjab
- C. Served as Nadir Shah's frontier army
- D. Established Bengal's revenue administration
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The movement survived the limits of Bahadur Shah's campaigning even though later Sikh phases lay beyond the core period.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 26 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not begin Sikh political history with Ranjit Singh.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 27 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about Rajput politics is most accurate?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. All Rajput houses formed one permanent anti-Mughal coalition
- B. Rajputs ceased receiving mansabs after 1707
- C. Rajput rulers could seek high Mughal office while bargaining for regional autonomy
- D. Their conflicts were purely religious
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Jai Singh and Ajit Singh demonstrate simultaneous imperial participation and regional assertion.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 27 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid binary loyalist/rebel labels.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 28 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The strongest common feature of Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad was:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Formal republican constitutions
- B. Complete abolition of Persian administration
- C. Direct creation by Ahmad Shah Durrani
- D. Provincial office converted into hereditary autonomy while Mughal legitimacy was retained
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** All three were successor states, but each rested on a distinct regional base.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 28 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Common origin does not make their later institutions identical.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 29 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Murshid Quli Khan's Bengal order depended significantly on:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Tight revenue collection, major zamindars and merchant-bankers
- B. Maratha control of the Bengal mint
- C. Abolition of land revenue
- D. Direct annual election by village councils
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Provincial fiscal capacity rested on collaboration with landed and financial elites.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 29 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Efficient collection could still be socially coercive.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 30 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The Jagat Seth house illustrates:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The disappearance of Indian bankers before Plassey
- B. The political importance of credit, remittance and mint-linked finance in Bengal
- C. A Sikh misl in Punjab
- D. A Mughal artillery corps
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** Bankers were not decorative merchants; they connected revenue, government and political coalition.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 30 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Commercial vitality did not guarantee political neutrality.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 31 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which best describes Saadat Khan's relation to Delhi?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. He immediately rejected every Mughal title
- B. He ruled Bengal as Murshid Quli's deputy
- C. He built Awadh autonomy while continuing to seek imperial office and confirmation
- D. He became Peshwa after Baji Rao
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Provincial state-building and court ambition remained intertwined.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 31 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not project later complete separation backward.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 32 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Hyderabad's continued use of the emperor's name on coins and in khutba indicates:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Direct daily taxation by Delhi
- B. Absence of any regional autonomy
- C. Conversion of Hyderabad into a European colony
- D. Layered sovereignty and the continuing value of Mughal legitimacy
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Symbolic recognition coexisted with practical independence in war, appointment and revenue.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 32 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Symbols are politically real but not proof of direct control.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 33 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement correctly distinguishes the three successor states?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Bengal was strongly commercial-fiscal, Awadh a Ganga-plain military-revenue state, Hyderabad a contested Deccan polity
- B. They had identical elite coalitions and geography
- C. Only Awadh retained Mughal forms
- D. All three were founded after Nadir Shah's death
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Common Mughal ancestry produced different regional trajectories.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 33 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: A matrix answer earns more than a generic list.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 34 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why is the phrase 'political vacuum' inadequate?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. No territory changed political hands
- B. Regional states, zamindars, Marathas and financiers exercised organised power as Delhi weakened
- C. The emperor maintained full coercive control
- D. European companies withdrew from India
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** Power was redistributed, not removed from society.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 34 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Rejecting 'vacuum' does not deny violent instability.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 35 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which was a central military weakness of the later Mughal host?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Complete absence of artillery
- B. Legal prohibition on cavalry
- C. Composite contingents and factional commanders lacked reliable unified coordination
- D. Dependence solely on European infantry
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Karnal shows how divided leadership nullified considerable resources.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 35 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not use a crude technology-only explanation.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 36 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

A high mansab in 1739 did not necessarily reveal:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The holder's nominal rank
- B. A recognised service status
- C. A claim on imperial patronage
- D. The number of paid, equipped and deployable soldiers actually present
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Fiscal shortfalls and inspection weakness separated paper strength from battlefield strength.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 36 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Nominal figures should not be treated as headcounts.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 37 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Nadir Shah's comparative military advantage is best stated as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Unified command, mobility, disciplined fire and flexible use of artillery
- B. Exclusive possession of all gunpowder technology
- C. Naval blockade of Delhi
- D. Support from a united Mughal nobility
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** The Mughals had guns; Nadir integrated force and decision more effectively.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 37 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid 'modern guns versus medieval swords'.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 38 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The northwest frontier failed before Karnal mainly because:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Kabul had never been connected to Mughal strategy
- B. Warnings, diplomacy, reinforcement and command were not converted into a coherent defensive system
- C. Nadir approached through Bengal
- D. The Marathas controlled Qandahar
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The court received embassies and reports but lacked timely institutional response.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 38 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Information alone is not preparedness.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 39 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Farukhsiyar's 1717 farman to the English Company primarily concerned:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Transfer of Bengal sovereignty to the Company
- B. Appointment of a Company governor of Awadh
- C. Commercial privileges in Bengal, later contested through passes and private trade
- D. Military conquest of Hyderabad
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** The farman was a legal-commercial privilege with later political consequences.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 39 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not convert trade privilege into territorial grant.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 40 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which economic statement is most defensible?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Every rupee not sent to Delhi disappeared from circulation
- B. Bengal trade ended in 1717
- C. Delhi had no commerce after 1739
- D. Decline in imperial remittance could coexist with stronger regional treasuries and markets
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Resources were redistributed toward regions, though social costs and war remained.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 40 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Centre and region must be analysed separately.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 41 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Satish Chandra's caution about Nadir Shah's booty is used to show that:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Famous totals should not be treated as proof of immediate all-India economic collapse
- B. No treasure was removed from Delhi
- C. The invasion had no fiscal effect
- D. The Peacock Throne remained in the Diwan-i-Khas
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Plunder was severe, but the scale and long-term economic interpretation require qualification.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 41 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid both exaggeration and minimisation.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 42 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Muhammad Shah's patronage of music and painting demonstrates:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Cultural patronage automatically restored provincial remittance
- B. Cultural vitality could coexist with political and military contraction
- C. Court music caused the jagirdari crisis
- D. Regional courts stopped supporting artists
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** Culture is an independent evidentiary dimension, not a proxy for governance.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 42 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not moralise aesthetic life into causation.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 43 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Dargah Quli Khan's Muraqqa-i Dehli is especially useful for:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Exact all-India peasant income statistics
- B. Official Persian casualty totals at Karnal
- C. Urban and courtly life in Muhammad Shah's Delhi
- D. The legal text of the 1717 farman
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** It supplies an urban social view that complements political chronicles.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 43 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Delhi-centred observation cannot represent every region.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 44 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which was a plausible motive for Nadir Shah's invasion?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A verified invitation from Nizam and Saadat Khan
- B. A plan to establish permanent Persian rule over Bengal
- C. A Sikh request to conquer Delhi
- D. Resources for a war-making Persian state combined with Mughal frontier weakness
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Fiscal-military motive, wealth and opportunity explain more than unsupported invitation stories.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 44 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Satish Chandra notes no documentary proof of the invitation claim.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 45 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The conventional modern date of the Battle of Karnal is:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. 24 February 1739
- B. 13 January 1719
- C. 24 February 1748
- D. 13 March 1757
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Modern reference works conventionally date Karnal to 24 February 1739.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 45 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not confuse Karnal with the first Durrani invasion in 1748.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 46 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Karnal is best interpreted as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The origin of every Mughal problem
- B. An external battlefield test that exposed pre-existing fiscal and command weakness
- C. A Maratha victory over Nadir Shah
- D. The formal end of the Mughal dynasty
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The invasion accelerated and publicised decline already visible in factions and regions.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 46 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Event and structural cause must be separated.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 47 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which claim about the Delhi massacre is methodologically safest?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. No civilian violence occurred
- B. Every chronicle gives the same number
- C. The massacre occurred, but a single precise casualty total should not be asserted as settled
- D. The event was invented by Company records
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Catastrophe is certain; totals vary across rhetorical and retrospective sources.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 47 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Numerical restraint is evidence discipline, not denial.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 48 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Nadir Shah's settlement with Muhammad Shah did which of the following?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Annexed the whole Gangetic plain to Persia
- B. Abolished the Mughal dynasty
- C. Installed the Sayyid Brothers as rulers
- D. Left Muhammad Shah on the throne while transferring wealth and frontier territories west of the Indus
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Nadir extracted and withdrew rather than constructing Persian government over north India.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 48 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Plunder and annexation west of the Indus are distinct from ruling Delhi.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 49 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which was not a consequence of 1739?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Immediate uniform destruction of all Indian trade and urban life
- B. Severe loss of imperial prestige
- C. Greater frontier exposure
- D. Encouragement to provincial and local assertion
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Delhi and regional commerce showed resilience even after a severe political-fiscal shock.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 49 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not infer all-India collapse from capital-city catastrophe.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 50 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The first Durrani invasion in 1748 is used here only to show:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The root cause of the 1707 succession war
- B. A bounded frontier consequence after Nadir's death and the continued possibility of Mughal resistance
- C. The creation of Rohilkhand
- D. The end of Maratha power in the Deccan
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** It lies at the edge of scope and should not displace the 1707-1739 explanation.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 50 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Keep later Afghan history bounded.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 51 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which causal ordering is strongest?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Culture declined, therefore jagirs disappeared
- B. Nadir invaded, therefore Aurangzeb fought in the Deccan
- C. Fiscal strain weakened service; weak service reduced collection; lower collection intensified faction and autonomy
- D. Company trade ended, therefore Bengal became rich
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** The decline operated through a self-reinforcing fiscal-political loop.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 51 · 2****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Good answers explain mechanisms, not just list factors.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 52 · 1****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Which statement best captures Mughal continuity?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Every successor state abolished mansabs immediately
- B. Persian ceased to be used after 1707
- C. The khutba lost all political meaning
- D. Regional powers appropriated imperial titles, documents and revenue practices even as Delhi lost command
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Continuity lowered the legitimacy cost of regional state formation.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 52 · 2****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Institutional survival does not mean unchanged operation.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 53 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Muzaffar Alam and C.A. Bayly are most useful for arguing that:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The eighteenth century involved regional reordering, commercial networks and redistributed power
- B. The Mughal centre remained fully sovereign
- C. Agrarian pressure never existed
- D. Nadir Shah created Bengal's banking system
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Revisionist work corrects a total-dark-age narrative.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 53 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: It must be balanced against warfare and unequal social costs.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 54 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Jadunath Sarkar's older interpretation is most often associated with:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A denial that emperors mattered
- B. Aurangzeb-centred, personality, moral and political decline
- C. The portfolio-capital thesis
- D. The claim that jagirs never existed
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The older view supplies political narrative but risks moral and communal reduction.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 54 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Name the interpretation and then qualify it.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 55 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is the best historiographical synthesis?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Only moral decay mattered
- B. No meaningful decline occurred at any level
- C. Central fiscal-military decline plus uneven regional state formation and continuing economic-cultural vitality
- D. Every region followed the same agrarian trajectory
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** A two-level, regionally qualified verdict incorporates the strongest evidence.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 55 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Balance does not mean treating every thesis as equally explanatory.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 56 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

A coin in Muhammad Shah's name issued within a successor state most directly proves:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Daily administrative control by Delhi
- B. Absence of regional taxation
- C. The emperor's personal presence at the mint
- D. A public claim to Mughal legitimacy
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Numismatic titlature reveals acknowledged sovereignty and political language.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 56 · 2****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Material symbols require an implementation limit.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 57 · 1****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Why could Mughal legitimacy survive military contraction?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. It remained a recognised language for title, succession, revenue rights and arbitration
- B. Regional rulers had no armies
- C. The emperor controlled every provincial treasury
- D. European companies prohibited local coins
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Existing institutions made imperial sanction useful even to autonomous powers.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 57 · 2****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Symbolic power can have practical political value.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 58 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which answer line is strongest for Aurangzeb's responsibility?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. He alone caused every event through religious policy
- B. His Deccan and coalition choices aggravated structural strain, but post-1707 institutions and actors determined the trajectory
- C. He had no role because he died in 1707
- D. His empire had already ceased to exist before his death
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** Balanced causation distinguishes inherited strain from later mechanisms.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 58 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid both exoneration and total blame.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 59 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about 'dark age' is most defensible?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. It is a precise statistical category
- B. It proves culture disappeared
- C. It captures real imperial and social disruption but fails as an all-region description
- D. It is fully refuted by one prosperous merchant
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** The period was neither uniform collapse nor uncomplicated regional prosperity.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 59 · 2GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Use levels, regions and social groups.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 60 · 1GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

The most useful final verdict on Nadir Shah is:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The sole structural cause
- B. Economically irrelevant
- C. Founder of a permanent Persian Mughal dynasty
- D. Decisive in timing and prestige, secondary to deeper causes of decline

- **Answer:** D

- **Explanation:** His invasion transformed perception and frontier security but depended on prior weakness.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 60 · 2GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Accelerant and revealer are not euphemisms for no impact.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Mains 10M-1 - Distinguish between decline, decentralisation and regionalisation in the Mughal context after 1707.GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 150 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- The terms identify different levels of the same transition. **Decline** refers to the loss of enforceable authority at Delhi: repeated succession struggles, the Sayyids' deposition of Farrukhsiyar in 1719 and divided command at Karnal in 1739 show that the emperor could no longer arbitrate elites or defend the frontier.

- **Decentralisation** describes the movement of revenue and appointment power from the centre to provinces. Murshid Quli Khan in Bengal, Saadat Khan in Awadh and Nizam-ul-Mulk in Hyderabad retained Mughal offices but made collection, military command and succession increasingly regional.

- **Regionalisation** goes further: provincial governors, zamindars, bankers and military groups formed durable political arenas. Bengal's large zamindars and Jagat Seth finance, Maratha chauth networks, and Jat-Sikh mobilisation reveal new coalitions below Delhi.

- The processes overlapped but were not identical. Coin, khutba, Persian chancery and imperial confirmation survived, so political force shifted before Mughal legitimacy disappeared. The period was therefore decline at the centre, decentralisation of functions and uneven regionalisation of power.

- **Why this earns marks:** It defines all three terms, supplies three distinct evidence clusters, shows overlap without collapsing categories and ends with a precise two-level verdict.

HIGH

Mains 10M-2 - Were the Sayyid Brothers merely destroyers of Mughal authority? Examine.

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 150 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- The Sayyid Brothers were both products and accelerants of the Mughal crisis, not merely destroyers. Abdullah Khan and Husain Ali raised Farrukhsiyar in 1713 because succession already depended on armed noble coalitions. Their conflict with him concerned the imperial seal, appointments, jagirs and Deccan resources - the substance of sovereignty.

- They also attempted repair. Satish Chandra records their abolition of jizya and pilgrim taxes, conciliation of Jai Singh, Ajit Singh and Churaman, and the 1718-19 settlement that exchanged recognition of Shahu's fiscal claims for Maratha support. These were efforts to widen the ruling coalition.

- Yet their deposition and killing of Farrukhsiyar in 1719 made Timurid monarchy visibly dependent on kingmakers. Rapid enthronements and patronage promises intensified jagir factionalism; opponents could then rally around dynasty, old nobility and religion. Husain Ali's assassination and Abdullah's defeat in 1720 ended their power, not the underlying crisis.

- Thus the Sayyids administered creatively under structural pressure, but their coercive kingmaking deepened the loss of monarchical authority.

- **Why this earns marks:** It directly tests the word 'merely', balances policies against consequences, names offices, rulers and settlements, and distinguishes symptom from agency.

HIGH

Mains 10M-3 - Explain why the invasion of Nadir Shah was an exposure rather than the origin of Mughal decline.

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 150 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- Nadir Shah's invasion was possible because the imperial system had already weakened. Before 1739, Farrukhsiyar had been deposed by noble kingmakers; Nizam-ul-Mulk had converted Deccan office into Hyderabad autonomy in 1724; Bengal and Awadh retained revenue; and mansabdars often failed to maintain full contingents because jagir yields and cash were unreliable.

- The frontier reproduced this failure. Delhi did not turn Nadir's repeated embassies or the fall of Qandahar and Kabul into timely reinforcement. At **Karnal, 24 February 1739**, Muhammad Shah's leading nobles disputed command. Saadat Khan engaged without an integrated plan, Khan-i-Dauran was mortally wounded, and Nadir's unified mobile force prevailed.

- The invasion nevertheless accelerated decline. Delhi suffered massacre and plunder; the emperor ceded territories west of the Indus; prestige collapsed; and regional actors saw that the centre could not protect itself. But Muhammad Shah remained emperor, Delhi recovered commercial life and Mughal legitimacy survived.

- Karnal was therefore an X-ray of a prior fiscal-command crisis and a severe new blow, not its original disease.

- **Why this earns marks:** It proves pre-existing weakness with four named units, explains Karnal's mechanism, gives real consequences and avoids minimising the invasion.

HIGH

Mains 15M-1 - Critically examine the jagirdari-agrarian crisis as an explanation of Mughal decline. · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 250 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- The jagirdari-agrarian thesis is powerful because it links elite politics, rural extraction and military weakness, but it must be regionally qualified.

- **Institutional mechanism:** Satish Chandra argues that mansab and salary claims outgrew dependable assignments. *Be-jagiri*, competition for productive jagirs and the diversion of khalisa weakened the centre's cash. The **jama-hasil** gap meant that paper assessment did not equal realised revenue.

- **Rural transmission:** Frequent transfer encouraged short-term extraction. Bipan Chandra notes the spread of **ijara**, under which contractors promised a fixed sum and sought profit from cultivators. Irfan Habib connects high surplus demand to peasant flight, arrears and zamindar-led Jat, Sikh and other resistance.

- **Military consequence:** Nobles with inadequate income did not maintain full contingents. Thus fiscal weakness reduced coercion; weaker coercion further reduced collection. Court parties then recruited followers by promising ranks and jagirs, as in the Farrukhsiyar-Sayyid conflict.

- **Qualifications:** John F. Richards asks whether Deccan revenues and khalisa choices made part of the scarcity policy-produced. Muzaffar Alam and C.A. Bayly point to agrarian growth, monetisation, bankers and regional states, showing that resources were redistributed rather than universally destroyed. Bengal's strong collection under Murshid Quli Khan is counter-evidence to an all-India production collapse, although it could burden smaller zamindars and peasants.

HIGH

Mains 15M-1 - Critically examine the jagirdari-agrarian crisis as an explanation of Mughal decline. · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Therefore the crisis is best treated as a variable mechanism: assignment, extraction and service diverged, but the degree and social outcome differed across regions.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Why this earns marks:** It defines the mechanism, uses Chandra, Habib, Richards and revisionist counter-evidence, connects fiscal and military outcomes and gives a qualified rather than absolute verdict.

HIGH

Mains 15M-2 - The Mughal successor states represented continuity in form and autonomy in substance. Discuss with reference to Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad. · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 250 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS**- Model answer**

- Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad did not emerge through one clean declaration of independence. They converted Mughal provincial office into hereditary regional authority while preserving the imperial idiom.

- **Bengal:** Murshid Quli Khan, confirmed governor in 1717, tightened survey and collection through powerful zamindars, transferred troublesome jagirdars and relied on merchant-bankers. Remittance and formal allegiance initially continued, but appointments and dynastic succession became provincial. The Jagat Seth house's later role in treasury and mint shows a regional fiscal coalition.

- **Awadh:** Saadat Khan, appointed in 1722, subdued local rajas and expanded provincial command. Yet he still sought imperial office. Safdar Jung's succession after 1739-40 required gifts and confirmation, proving that autonomy and Timurid sanction reinforced each other.

- **Hyderabad:** Nizam-ul-Mulk left the wizarat and defeated Mubariz Khan in 1724. He conducted war, appointment and revenue regionally, while coins, khutba and mansab vocabulary retained Muhammad Shah's sovereignty. Deccan merchants, revenue intermediaries and military elites gave the state its distinct base.

- The states also differed: Bengal was a rich agrarian-commercial province, Awadh a middle-Ganga military-revenue arena and Hyderabad a multi-centred Deccan polity constrained by Marathas and local chiefs.

HIGH

Mains 15M-2 - The Mughal successor states represented continuity in form and autonomy in substance. Discuss with reference to Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad. · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Thus Mughal administrative forms reduced the cost of regional state-building, while control over revenue and force moved decisively away from Delhi.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Why this earns marks:** It compares three states through the same analytical headings, supplies named fiscal and legitimacy evidence, states regional differences and answers both continuity and autonomy.

HIGH

Mains 15M-3 - How far was Aurangzeb responsible for the decline of the Mughal Empire? · 1

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Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 250 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- Aurangzeb was substantially responsible for intensifying the empire's constraints, but he cannot be made the single cause of a decline worked out after 1707.

- **Real responsibility:** The long Deccan commitment absorbed treasury and troops, added difficult territories and failed to extinguish Maratha mobility. Incorporating Deccani and Maratha entrants increased claims on mansabs and jagirs. The emperor's prolonged southern presence weakened supervision of the north and northwest. Conflict over Marwar damaged a Rajput alliance central to Mughal power; jizya and some temple policies narrowed legitimacy in places.

- **Necessary qualification:** Bipan Chandra notes that administration, army and dynastic prestige remained substantial at Aurangzeb's death. Religious measures were reversed: Bahadur Shah and later the Sayyids restored broad accommodation, while Hindu and Muslim nobles repeatedly allied across faith for office and revenue.

- **Post-1707 mechanisms:** Succession wars killed commanders and made noble coalitions decisive. The Sayyids deposed Farrukhsiyar; Nizam-ul-Mulk regionalised Deccan power; jagir and agrarian pressures weakened contingents; Bengal and Awadh retained revenue; and Muhammad Shah's nobles failed to coordinate at Karnal.

- Jadunath Sarkar's ruler-centred reading therefore identifies important agency but becomes inadequate when communal or moral blame replaces institutional evidence. Satish Chandra's jagirdari-Deccan synthesis better explains transmission.

HIGH

Mains 15M-3 - How far was Aurangzeb responsible for the decline of the Mughal Empire? · 2

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Aurangzeb aggravated the inheritance; later fiscal, political and regional choices converted strain into systemic decline.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers 'how far' with concession, qualification and ranking; uses Deccan, Rajput, jizya, Sayyids, successor states and Karnal; and attributes historiography accurately.

HIGH

Mains 20M-1 - Why did Mughal central authority decline between 1707 and the 1740s? Present a weighted multi-causal explanation. · 1

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Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 350 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- Mughal central authority declined because the fiscal-military contract that joined emperor, nobility, province and countryside ceased to reproduce revenue, service and obedience. Weak rulers and invasion mattered, but they operated through a deeper interactive crisis.

- **1. Inherited over-extension:** Aurangzeb left a formidable empire, yet the long Deccan war had tied down forces, complicated jagir allocation and failed to eliminate Maratha mobility. Rajput and Punjab difficulties and weakened northwest attention added strain. This was a difficult inheritance, not inevitable collapse.

- **2. Succession and arbitration:** With no fixed succession rule, Jajau in 1707 and the contests after Bahadur Shah's death consumed soldiers and made the throne dependent on noble coalitions. Farrukhsiyar's deposition in 1719 showed that kingmakers could control monarchy; rapid enthronements weakened dynastic awe.

- **3. Jagirdari-fiscal mechanism:** Satish Chandra's *be-jagiri* thesis links a growing body of claimants to inadequate or low-yield assignments. Jama exceeded hasil, khalisa was granted away and frequent transfer promoted short-term extraction. Under ijara, contractors pressed cultivators for profit. Nobles in arrears maintained incomplete contingents.

- **4. Agrarian and regional feedback:** Irfan Habib connects extraction to peasant and zamindar resistance. Jats, Sikhs, Bundelas and local chiefs withheld revenue and fortified power. Revisionist evidence adds that agrarian growth, bankers and monetisation could strengthen regions: Murshid Quli Khan's Bengal was fiscally vigorous even as Delhi lost remittance.

HIGH

Mains 20M-1 - Why did Mughal central authority decline between 1707 and the 1740s? Present a weighted multi-causal explanation. · 2

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5. Provincial and Maratha reordering: Saadat Khan's Awadh and Nizam-ul-Mulk's Hyderabad converted office into autonomy while retaining imperial legitimacy. Maratha chauth and sardeshmukhi moved from contested exaction to imperial bargaining in 1718-19 and wider expansion under Baji Rao.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **6. Military-command failure:** The army retained artillery and numbers, but paper mansabs, arrears, slow logistics and factional command reduced usable strength. At Karnal in 1739, divided Mughal action faced Nadir's integrated mobility and fire discipline.

- **7. External shock:** Nadir's victory, the Delhi massacre, plunder and loss west of the Indus devastated prestige and frontier security. Yet regional autonomy and fiscal weakness clearly predated him.

- The causal order is therefore weighted: fiscal-military and political structures formed the core; rural and regional movements amplified them; military underperformance transmitted them; Nadir determined the dramatic timing and visibility of collapse. Mughal legitimacy and institutions survived, so the outcome was central decline with uneven regional transition, not instant disappearance.

- **Why this earns marks:** It gives a ranked mechanism rather than a list, uses more than eight named evidence units, separates inherited strain from post-1707 transmission, integrates revisionist counter-evidence and ends with a level-specific verdict.

HIGH

Mains 20M-2 - Was the eighteenth century in India a 'dark age' of decline or an age of regional transformation? Critically discuss with reference to 1707-1740s. · 1

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Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 350 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- Neither label is sufficient alone. The period was a darkening of Mughal central fiscal-military capacity and, simultaneously, an uneven transformation of political and economic power toward regions.

- **Evidence for decline:** Succession contests after 1707 destroyed continuity and empowered factions. Farrukhsiyar's deposition by the Sayyids in 1719 eroded monarchical prestige. Jagir competition, jama-hasil gaps and ijara shifted pressure toward cultivators; Jat, Sikh and zamindar resistance disrupted revenue. Provincial remittance weakened, mansabdars under-maintained contingents and Nadir Shah's victory at Karnal in 1739 culminated in massacre, plunder and frontier loss.

- Older narratives associated with Jadunath Sarkar read these developments through Aurangzeb, weak successors and moral-political decay. They preserve chronology and agency but risk treating court conduct and religious policy as complete causation.

- **Evidence for transformation:** Bengal under Murshid Quli Khan created a strong revenue order supported by large zamindars and bankers. Saadat Khan's Awadh and Nizam-ul-Mulk's Hyderabad retained Mughal titles, coins, khutba and administration while regionalising force and revenue. Maratha networks converted chauth and sardeshmukhi into a wide political system; Jats and Sikhs built durable local mobilisation.

- Muzaffar Alam and C.A. Bayly therefore stress decentralisation, regional politics, credit and "portfolio" resources. Cultural evidence strengthens the case: Dargah Quli Khan's Delhi, Muhammad Shah's music and painting, and the movement of Persianate forms to regional courts contradict total civilisational collapse. Satish Chandra even cautions that the famous economic effect of Nadir's booty is often overstated.

HIGH

Mains 20M-2 - Was the eighteenth century in India a 'dark age' of decline or an age of regional transformation? Critically discuss with reference to 1707-1740s. · 2

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Social and regional qualification: Regional vitality could rest on coercive collection. Murshid Quli's efficient Bengal disadvantaged smaller zamindars; warfare and revenue farming exposed peasants and artisans. Delhi's recovery cannot represent every devastated corridor.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- The best synthesis is a two-level history: the imperial centre declined catastrophically, while political authority, commerce and culture were reorganised through regions with unequal benefits and costs. "Transition" is the broader category; "decline" remains indispensable for Delhi's lost capacity.

- **Why this earns marks:** It constructs and tests both sides with political, fiscal, regional, economic and cultural evidence; names historiographical positions; adds social costs; and delivers a non-evasive critical verdict.

HIGH

Mains 20M-3 - Analyse the relationship between military weakness, regional autonomy and the survival of Mughal legitimacy in the early eighteenth century. · 1

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Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 350 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- The apparent paradox of the early eighteenth century is that Mughal military enforcement contracted while Mughal legitimacy remained the preferred language of new power. The two developments were connected.

- **Military weakness:** The mansab system mobilised composite noble contingents, not one uniformly drilled standing army. Jagir arrears and weak inspection meant that sanctioned rank exceeded deployable troops. Heavy artillery, large camps and capable cavalry remained, but factional commanders disputed precedence and plan. At Karnal in 1739, Saadat Khan's uncoordinated engagement, Khan-i-Dauran's fatal intervention and Nizam-ul-Mulk's constrained role allowed Nadir Shah's unified mobile force to defeat a larger host.

- **Regional autonomy as response:** Where Delhi could not guarantee assignment, protection or arbitration, powerful office-holders internalised resources. Murshid Quli Khan made Bengal's revenue administration provincial; Saadat Khan subdued Awadh's chiefs; Nizam-ul-Mulk transformed the Deccan viceroyalty into Hyderabad after 1724. Marathas extracted chauth and sardeshmukhi, while Jats, Sikhs and zamindars built armed local networks. Military labour and finance followed reliable regional patrons.

- **Why legitimacy survived:** None of these actors operated in an institutional vacuum. The Timurid emperor could still grant mansabs, titles, farmans and sanads that rival claimants recognised. Hyderabad retained coin and khutba in the emperor's name; Safdar Jung sought confirmation in Awadh; Maratha leaders sought imperial documentary recognition; the English Company relied on Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman.

- **Significance:** Mughal forms reduced the legitimacy cost of decentralisation. A governor could exercise independent war and taxation while presenting succession as lawful continuity. Control of the emperor therefore remained valuable even after he lost provincial command.

HIGH

Mains 20M-3 - Analyse the relationship between military weakness, regional autonomy and the survival of Mughal legitimacy in the early eighteenth century. · 2

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Limit: Symbols were not mere fiction, but neither did they restore cash or battlefield coordination. Their practical effect depended on recognition by nobles, zamindars, merchants and rival states.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Thus military weakness shifted protection and patronage to regions, while the shared Mughal administrative-cultural order enabled that shift to occur without an immediate formal rupture. Force regionalised faster than legitimacy.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the relationship rather than three separate themes, uses Karnal, three successor states, Marathas and documentary/numismatic evidence, and distinguishes practical symbolic power from direct control.